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WEDNESDAY, JANUARY 8, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Trump hints at use of military force

Says Panama Canal, Greenland now vital to national security

By Will Weissert and Zeke Miller
Associated Press

PALM BEACH, Fla. — President-elect Donald Trump on Tuesday said he would not rule out the use of military force to seize control of the Panama Canal and Greenland, as he declared U.S. control of both to be vital to American national security.

Speaking to reporters less than two weeks before he takes office on Jan. 20 and as a delegation of aides and advisers that includes Donald Trump Jr. is in Greenland, Trump left open the use of the American military to secure both territories. Trump's intention marks a rejection of decades of U.S. policy that has prioritized self-determination over territorial expansion.

"I'm not going to commit to that," Trump said, when asked if he would rule out the use of the military. "It might be that you'll have to do something. The Panama Canal is vital to our country." He added, "We need Greenland for national security purposes."

Greenland, home to a large U.S. military base, is an autonomous territory of Denmark, a longtime U.S. ally and a founding member of NATO. Trump cast doubts on the legitimacy of Denmark's claim to Greenland.

The Panama Canal has been solely controlled by Panama for more than 25 years. The U.S. returned the Panama Canal Zone to the country in 1979 and ended its joint partnership in controlling the strategic waterway in 1999.

Addressing Trump's comments in an interview with Danish broadcaster TV2, Prime Minister Mette Frederiksen called the United States Denmark's "most important and closest ally," and that she did not believe that the United States will use military or economic power to secure control over Greenland.

Frederiksen repeated that she welcomed the United States taking a greater interest in the

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MICHAEL MADIGAN TRIAL



Former Illinois House Speaker Michael Madigan leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago after taking the stand in his own public corruption trial Tuesday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Madigan takes stand in federal corruption trial

Ex-Illinois House speaker says he never traded his public office for private gain

By Jason Meisner, Megan Crepeau and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

For decades, Michael Madigan reigned over the Capitol in relative secrecy.

Where many Illinois politicians tended toward braggadocio, the longtime Democratic House speaker was notoriously taciturn. He rarely let his guard down in public, spoke to journalists in cryptic sentences, and left his motivations opaque to every-

one but a tiny circle of insiders.

Madigan derived significant power from that mystique, often remaining so silent behind closed doors that he earned a nickname: "The Sphinx."

But at Madigan's federal corruption trial Tuesday, the Sphinx started talking.

In a stunning and risky move, Madigan, once the state's most powerful politician, took the witness stand in his own defense, offering wide-ranging testimony about his strict Irish Catholic upbringing and rise to power in

Springfield as well as repeated and emphatic denials that he ever betrayed his elected position.

"Did you ever trade your public office for private gain?" Madigan's lawyer, Dan Collins, asked just minutes into his testimony.

Madigan turned his face toward the jury box and answered, "No."

"Did you ever demand a thing of value in exchange for a promise to take official action?" Collins asked. "Did you ever accept a thing of value in exchange for a promise to take official action?"

To both, Madigan answered no.

U.S. District Judge John Robert Blakey's courtroom was at capacity when Madigan, dressed in a gray suit and blue and red tie, was called to the witness stand, snapping the jury to attention.

With a crew of Madigan supporters, including his daughter Lisa, the former state attorney general, looking on from the front row, Madigan was sworn in and took his seat, unscrewing

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INSIDE



KENT NISHIMURA/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Jimmy Carter lies in state

The coffin of former President Jimmy Carter arrives at the Capitol Rotunda in Washington with members of Congress and guests on hand Tuesday. **Nation & World**

Bald eagle felled by bird flu

The raptor, found in Hinsdale on Friday, was euthanized at the DuPage Wildlife Conservation Center. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

Nicor seeks \$309M delivery rate hike

The increase would raise delivery charges by 20% for Chicago-area customers. Regulators have 11 months to review the proposal. **Business**

Feud over hemp bill dominates final days of legislative session

Pritzker, Johnson lobby on opposing sides of measure

By Jeremy Gorner and Addison Wright
Chicago Tribune

SPRINGFIELD — The legislation passed and sent to Gov. JB Pritzker's desk during the General Assembly's brief lame-duck session was overshadowed by the governor's squabble with Chicago Mayor Brandon Johnson over a bill that never got called for a vote.

Pritzker and Johnson each mounted serious lobbying attempts on opposing sides of a bill to strictly regulate hemp sales. The disagreement was emblematic of the tense working relationship the two leaders have maintained since Johnson took office in May 2023.

Ultimately, Johnson's side of the argument prevailed, and Pritzker proved a not particularly gracious loser, saying the mayor had little to do with the result and indicating the blame lies with his fellow Democrats led by House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch.



Dusk falls in the snow on the Illinois Capitol building on Tuesday in Springfield. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

"I was tremendously disappointed that this is a demonstration, from my perspective, of the power of special interests and the money that they spread around to thwart health and safety of the public," Pritzker said Tuesday during an unrelated news conference in downstate Normal. He said the hemp bill's demise resulted from "the choice by a number of people to go for prof-

its over people."

The bill, which would have licensed and regulated hemp that is used for products such as delta-8 and delta-10 THC that get users high, passed in the state Senate with nearly no opposition during the spring legislative session. But it proved to be a hard sell in the House, where some

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TODAY'S WEATHER



High 24 Low 12

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 16

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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